

Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

July 2026

£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



**St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley**
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

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St. Mary's, Kington PCC is a registered charity and its number is 1185453

Notes from the Curate

I write this having just returned from a week's holiday in Wales. We rented a cottage in a small village between St David's and Fishguard. On most days we would find a new cove to explore. The nearest was a small harbour called Abercastle. The natural landscape funnelled the sea through a gap between protruding cliffs into the harbour. As I looked towards the sea, the power of the waves as they rose and then broke on the horizon was impressive. It was both a visual and audible spectacle, only enhanced by the brisk salty sea breeze. These experiences somehow allow me to connect deeply with God, and I came away feeling briefly exhilarated.

Sometimes I can become overwhelmed with what seems to be an endless list of everyday tasks and have a habit of spending too much time worrying about things that might never

**...but what this passage
does tell me is that Jesus
was just as human as you
and me. Someone who
also needed a holiday.**

happen (and with hindsight often don't). The fatigue that comes with managing our everyday tasks and relationships is not something Jesus was immune to. In Mark's Gospel (7:24-30), Jesus travels to Tyre to escape the crowds, he did not want anyone to know where he was going.

Tyre is an ancient coastal port which is today located in southern Lebanon. The city is thought to be one of the oldest cities in the

world, being inhabited for approximately 4700 years!

A busy place outside the boundaries of Israel, yet the news about Jesus and his ministry had even reached here.

Jesus' location did not remain secret for long. A woman with a sick daughter discovered where he was and came and begged him to heal her daughter. Jesus' response in the English translation reads as being initially dismissive. As the conversation evolves the woman's persistence and faith pay off. Jesus heals her daughter. Many have pondered the nature of Jesus' response. Was he annoyed by the request? Was his priority to the Jewish people first? Was he just teasing the women in order to gain the attention of other people in the room? I do not know the answer, but what this passage does tell me is that Jesus was just as human as you and me. Someone who also needed a holiday.

But as with all Gospel stories there is always more. Even when Jesus is tired, he has compassion on those in need regardless of their gender, status or ethnic origin. How many of us can claim to do this? We also see that by healing the child, Jesus is more than just human, he is God incarnate. He has the power to change people's lives in an instant. I think this is why I feel close to God by the coast, because the power of the wind and the waves give me a brief glimpse of the power and authority of God. A God who cares for each and every one of us.

Phillipa



St. Mary's Church, Kington

As I write this it is cold and showery. Perhaps by the time you are reading it, we will have a heatwave....?

Carpets...

These were wearing out, and have now been removed, to reveal some beautiful tiles in the chancel, and in the main body of the church, which are all in much better condition than we feared. We have also uncovered some grave slabs, one dating from 1687, and several from the 17th century. We will now get professional advice about cleaning and restoring the floor. Do come and admire a work in progress. The church is open from 9am daily, with DIY tea, coffee, and biscuits.

Concerts at St. Mary's

Our next concert will be on Friday 3rd July at 7pm in church, with music for organ and cello. Hilary Norris from Leominster Abbey will be playing the organ. Tickets £12, on the door, to include wine, fruit juice and nibbles. Do come along.

Pilgrimages

Benefice pilgrimages are taking place over the summer. Kington's is on Sunday 20th September at 2pm from the church, an approximately 3 mile walk ending with tea and cakes in church on your return. Do save the date.

Ordination

Phillippa will be ordained on Saturday 4th July in the Cathedral. On Sunday 5th July there will be a Benefice Communion service at 11am in St. Mary's, followed by a Bring and Share lunch in church. Do bring some food to share, and come and join the celebration.



All our usual activities are carrying on over the summer – Beetle Drives, Wild Church, Stay and Play (in term time), and Lego Club. See the back cover for dates and times, come and join in!

With our very best wishes to you all,
Margaret Cooke and Greg Wright,
churchwardens.



– Kington Creations –

St Mary's Lego Club

Thousands of bricks, Lots of mini figures,
Loads of fun !

Wednesday 22nd July

3:30pm – 5:00pm

St Marys Church Kington

Young children to be accompanied
by an adult please

Refreshments available
legoclub.kington@gmail.com

Having fun creating together



St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

The popular Huntington Fete is a fun filled afternoon for all the family. Come along and join in all the fun and games and meet old friends you may not have seen for some time. Perhaps purchase some of the delicious cakes, jams or preserves, a couple of plants for your garden, or you may find a bargain on the bric-a-brac stall. Then sit and relax with a cup of tea and piece of cake and enjoy a traditional village fete in the beautiful grounds of Huntington Court. See poster for details.

Susan Maiden



Huntington Fete

July 18th

3pm - 5pm

at Huntington Court

**teas * games * plants
ice creams * bric-a-brac**

FREE ADMISSION • FREE PARKING



New!



Stay and Play

Baby & Toddler Group

**For parents and carers with
children aged 0-3, no booking
required.**

St Mary's Parish Hall

(parking at rear)

Tuesdays 9:15-10:45

Term Time Only



**Light refreshments, stories and
songs, lots of toys, themed activities.**

**Group provided by St Mary's Kingston PCC. Suggested
donation £2**

Barnabas Breakfast

A very big thank you to everyone who participated in the Barnabas Breakfast on Ascension Day.

Twenty-eight people joined us for a full English breakfast of bacon, eggs and sausages supplied by local farms accompanied with tomatoes, mushrooms and beans; toast, tea and coffee too!

Stefan Jones from Barnabas Aid came and spoke to us about the project to supply one million chickens and one million pigs to farmers and pastors in countries where Christians are marginalised and facing poverty.

He was very encouraged by the number of people who came to support the breakfast and their generosity.

Together we raised £345.



St. Peter's Church

Titley

Readers

Sunday 5th July 8.30am Jeremy

Sunday 19th July 10am Dick

Flowers

Flowers for July Elizabeth.

Community Shop

We will be running the Community Shop in September again. Please do start to see what you have that we can sell in the shop. Items for sale can be stored in the back of the church. If you need a van to collect anything, please get in touch with Dick on 01544 231052 and any offers of help in the shop please do give Judith Jones a ring on 01544 230734.

Condolences

We send our prayers and thoughts to John and all the family of Quita Sankey who sadly passed away on Saturday 13th June. She will always be remembered for those baking those famous homemade cakes.

Village Fete

A reminder that our Village Fete takes place on Saturday 9th August on the Stag Meadow, by kind permission of David Forbes. Please see the Competition Schedule and have a go in as many classes as you can.

Titley Pilgrim Walk

A reminder that the Titley Pilgrim Walk takes place on Sunday 19th July. Meet at the church at 1.45pm. Refreshments will be served at the end. To book your place please phone Rev Sally Welch on 07974439630

Many thanks

Dick

St Mary's Church Kington

ORGAN
& CELLO
RECITAL



Friday 3rd July
7.00 pm

Hilary Norris & Joris Boon

Tickets at the door: £12.00 (including refreshments)

TITLEY FETE SATURDAY 8TH AUGUST 2026

COOKERY SECTION

1. NON-ALCOHOLIC DRINK/COCKTAIL
2. PLOUGHMANS LUNCH – JUDGED ON PRESENTATION ONLY
3. JAR OF CHUTNEY – INGREDIENTS TO BE DISPLAYED
4. JAR OF MARMALADE – CAN BE “FLAVOURED”
5. 5 GLUTEN FREE BLONDIES
6. 2 HOMEMADE SCONES WITH BUTTER, JAM & CREAM – PHYLIS LEWIS ROSE BOWL

FLORAL/VEGETABLE & HANDICRAFT SECTION

7. JAM JAR OF GARDEN FLOWERS
8. FLOWER ARRANGEMENT IN A WINE GLASS
9. LONGEST RUNNER BEAN
10. A DISPLAY OF WONKY VEGETABLES
11. ITEM OF CRAFT IN ANY MEDIUM

OPEN CLASS

12. HOW MANY DIFFERENT ITEMS CAN YOU GET IN A MATCH BOX – YOU CAN USE EITHER A SWAN VESTA MATCH BOX OR A COOKS MATCH BOX – PRIZE FOR BOTH SIZES
12. DESIGN NEXT YEARS FETE POSTER – SATURDAY 14TH AUGUST 2027

CHILDRENS – IT’S THE YEAR THAT YOUR CHILD HAS JUST FINISHED, BUT THEY CAN ENTER THE ABOVE YEARS IF THEY WANT TO

NURSERY – FINGER PRINT PAINTING

RECEPTION – 3 DECORATED BISCUITS – BOUGHT BISCUITS CAN BE USED

YEAR 1 – DECORATED STONE

YEAR 2 – TOILET ROLL CREATION

YEAR 3 – PAPERCHAIN ANIMAL

YEAR 4 – A DECORATED PAPER WINDMILL

YEAR 5 – GARDEN ON A PLATE

YEAR 6 – JUNK MODEL

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

1. All classes are open.
2. No exhibitor is allowed to take more than one prize in any one class.
3. The judge’s decision is final.
4. Exhibits to be staged between 10.30am and 12noon and not removed before 4.00pm.
5. All entries are to be exhibitor’s own work.
6. Entry fees: adults 25p, children free.
7. Numbers to be collected from the secretary at time of staging.
8. The committee are not responsible for loss or damage to exhibits.

Kington Celebrates on Saturday 27th June, 2026



ARMED FORCES DAY SHOW YOUR SUPPORT

Lady Hawkins' School, HR5 3AR

Opening Ceremony: 11:00 at the School War Memorial

Join us for a day full of pride, fun, and community spirit! Celebrate and show your support for our Armed Forces with activities, entertainment, and refreshments for all ages.

- Live music performances
- Stalls and stands of related charities
- Food, drinks and refreshments available
- Meet local past /present service members
- Vintage Military Vehicles on show

Everyone welcome – come along and show your support!

Reader Writes

Father David drew his scythe in wide skilled sweeps, whispering to the earth.

The churchyard grasses and flowers fell in neat rows. He liked this job. After the great storm of 35 the church was no longer safe; in the dark interior the pigeons cooed on their ledges and discretely came and went where there were missing slates. Ongoing repairs struggled to keep up. The “problem” was the demands of a

church that kept growing and spreading. After the election of 29 it hadn’t taken long for the world to find itself wrestling with a wide range of challenges, from climate down to welfare. A new era, new challenges; the work of the church had just begun.

Fortunately, church and community were used to working together. A workshop in the years before, called Growing Good, sought to strengthen church connection with its community. The devil would love the faithful to feel so comfortable inside the church that they seldom felt the need to go out. But scripture calls us to be spiritual ambassadors and soldiers in the faith. A Growing Good principle was **Participation**. How often we thought we participated in the community but did little. Active membership of a pub, keeping allotments, the prayer bench in Bradnor coppice, a thriving Open Arms Kington, music and choirs, art and sports, all this had become more important in their lives.

For many, **Hospitality**, another Growing Good principle, became a core part of church life. Homes were places of nurture and support. Over a pot of tea or strong coffee, neighbours were asking questions, making

friends, sharing hopes and burdens, and all the time of course there is prayer. The church itself, once the roof was safe, could offer hospitality; and in Kington’s High Street there is a project called The Dove. It had once been a pub, but after conversion The Dove played host for many small gatherings, crafts, including spinning and weaving, and providing hospitality wherever there was opportunity.

The many campaigns in defence of **Justice** sometimes became a more controversial

**“I am the vine and
you are the branches.
Whoever abides in me
and I in him, he it is
that bears much fruit,
for apart from me you
can do nothing.”**

principle. Several church members had been active in the local Palestine Study Group. The Middle East wars had stirred up huge indignation. London peace rallies drew busloads of “cardboard terrorists”. There was strong support for them from both town and church. Justice had also become a contended issue over the needs of care workers and the staffing of the NHS.

The church had been a recognised agent in supporting compassionate immigration; yet it hadn’t taken long for that same community to find itself facing obstacles. Suddenly Justice became the issue rather than hospitality.

Jesus’ words in John 15 are hugely encouraging as we prepare for the opportunities of the future: *“I am the vine and you are the branches. Whoever abides in me and I in him, he it is that bears much fruit, for apart from me you can do nothing.”* He goes on to spell out that when we ‘abide’ in him, that is when we are truly engaged in his work of expansion and blessing, we can ask for whatever we need and it will be given. Community or church, we are to abide in him, even when, storms rip slates off, pigeons nest where unintended and grass needs scything.

Robert MacCurrach

7 God by Numbers

a sacred number, is referenced many times in the Bible. The Jewish seven candle stick, the menorah, symbolises the temple in Jerusalem and the sacred light of God's presence and provision. Six symbolized the incompleteness of humanity without God and contrasted with seven which is the divine perfection. The children of Israel circled Jerico seven times before the walls came tumbling down. The Ethiopian leper, Naaman, after protest, consented to dip himself in the Jordan seven times to be cleansed.

For Christians the fundamental importance of seven is in the creation. God created the world in six days, and on the seventh day he rested from all his work. The Sabbath, that seventh day, is part of our life of worship, recognising and celebrating God's provision and blessing for us. On the seventh we are commanded to take stock, rest, and consider God's part in our lives.

Jubilee (seven times seven years) presented in the law part of the bible, emphasises another aspect to Sabbath rest. In the year of Jubilee there was to be a reset; those who had lost freedom or been forced to sell their land would have it returned. This concept of ownership is entirely out of step with contemporary capitalism; neoliberalism takes profit and secures property even at the expense of the poor, a growing impoverished class. It also extracts profit at the expense of the environment. The idea of a Jubilee essentially acknowledges that God is the owner of the land, and we, his servants, are but his tenants. When we buy land or labour, we are buying the production from that land and labour rather than acquiring the means of subsistence. Seven, a different world.

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns

Kington Art and Craft Market

The July Art and Craft Market
will be on

Saturday 18th July
9.30am - 3.00pm

at the Market Hall, Kington.

Kington Art & Craft Market offers a wide variety of unique items from different local Artists and Crafters. We have something for everyone. Our stalls offer sewn, crochet & knitted items; papercraft and cards; pottery, basketry and engraving; felted items, jewellery, and honey products along with our different artists and much more. So please put the date in your diary, pop along to see us and support local artists and crafters in their work.

It is the perfect place to find a Birthday, Wedding Gift or Card, or just to treat yourself

***We look forward to seeing
you on 18th July.***

Kington Parishes: June 2026

Sunday, 5th Trinity 5

Genesis 24:34-38, 42-49, 58-end, Psalm 45:10-end, Romans 7:15-25a, Matthew 11:16-19, 25-end

11.00am Benefice Communion and Lunch: Kington *

Sunday, 12th Trinity 6

Genesis 25:19-end, Psalm 119, 105-112, Romans 8:1-11, Matthew 13:1-9, 18-23

8.30am: Holy Communion: Huntington

10.00am: Holy Communion: Kington *

11.00am Holy Communion with Baptism: Old Radnor

12.30pm: Wild Church Cookout Kington

Sunday, 19th Trinity 7

Genesis 28:10-19a, Psalm 139:1-11, Romans 8:12-25, Matthew 13:24-30, 36-43

10.00am: Holy Communion: Titley

11.00am: Morning Praise: Kington *

11.30am Baptism: Kington

6.00pm: Evening Prayer: Old Radnor

Sunday, 26th Trinity 8

Genesis 29:15-28, Psalm 105:1-11, Romans 8:26-end, Matthew 13:31-35

10.00am: Holy Communion: Kington *

6.00pm: Sung Evensong: Huntington

* These services are live streamed.

WEEKDAY SERVICES

Morning Prayer takes place at 9am in Kington every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, and Evening Prayer at 4pm on Mondays. All are welcome.

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

Purcell

I Was Glad



with

Organ: Paul Roberts

The Marches Camerata

Conductor: Simon Harper

Haydn

Little Organ Mass

Ave Verum Corpus

Laudate Dominum

Mozart

Vivaldi

Gloria

Concerto for Strings in A

**Friday
3rd July**

St Andrew's, Presteigne

7.30pm

£15 (<18s free)

Soprano
Naomi Sturges

Mezzo-soprano
Hannah Beddoe



Tickets from kingtonchoral.org.uk or trybooking.com
Salty Dog (Presteigne); Border Bean (Kington);
and Tower House Gallery (Knighton) - cash only



Poster design - Terry Wells

MONTHLY MUSINGS

*And so we come to Castle Twts,
where once a wooden lookout stood,
no trace or vestige of it left, the mound is
bare,
no thickset growth as you will find
on castle mounds elsewhere,
at Kington, for example, and at Huntington,
whose castles were of stone
leaving a rich deposit of lime mortar
when demolished,
on which rough briars and shrubs have
thickly grown.*

*It stands, this mound of Castle Twts,
above a crossing of the Arrow,
here where two ancient pilgrim routes
converged; the one, this drovers' narrow
sunken hollow-road, pilgrims would follow
and westwards, t'wards St David's turn.
(St David's, such a long and arduous trek
from home
that those who did it twice would simply earn
as many brownie points as going once to
Rome)*

*The other route led to the holy shrine
at Hereford of Ethelbert the King,
where many pilgrims healing sought
with prayer and votive offering,*

*And maybe, by this crossing of two routes,
as elsewhere too, at any holy site,
would dwell a hermit or an anchorite,
offering weary pilgrims simple shelter
and protection for the night,
these, at the break of yet another day,
refreshed and blessed
would be sent plodding early on their way.*

Ascension Day, and in spite of a woeful forecast, we felt compelled to climb to the summit of Castle Twts, ideally, but impracticably, to celebrate the Eucharist. But perhaps we might do that on the table by the pool in Park Wood. Anyway: *Nothing attempted, nothing achieved*. So we packed our rucksacks and set off (no rain yet) at about 10:15, in time to celebrate communion (no hymns) at about eleven.

This was a bit special – the trees loved it! It was as we packed everything away that the heavens opened and a sharp shower showed its appreciation! The rain graciously eased up a bit, so we persisted, taking the footpath for Castle Twts and climbing to the summit. And I here confess to being a naughty boy by reserving the Ascension Day Gospel for this moment, ignoring the drizzle and declaiming it at the top of my voice. Naughtiness for which I was punished by my dizziness, straining, as I attempted the descent from this (the peak of my pride?) some muscles in my thighs, which meant a painful walk home along the main road supported by Emma, God bless her! And she's knowledgeable about these things, explaining that all I needed in order to recover was rice! So, should I look forward to some nice rice pudding at dinner time? It was only later that I learnt from her that RICE is an acronym. **Rest, Ice, Compression, Elevation**. And it worked, taking me less than a week to recover!

Denis Parry.

Operation Dove

Once again, I have to report that we are still waiting for planning permission from Hereford County Council before significant work can start on the Dove, but work is about to begin removing all the old wiring from the cellar and ground floor area so that new wiring can be installed. This work will be combined with providing additional fire-retardant panels to the ceiling in order to improve the safety of the occupant of the flat on the 1st and 2nd floor of the building. A commercial standard fire alarm system will also be installed.

In the courtyard, which will provide a very useful space for social and fundraising events, two of the five wooden picnic benches have been removed, and the remaining three have been painted in pastel shades. The walls where the old staging had been situated have also been painted, and summer bedding plants in the recycled planters make the whole area very attractive.

We recently purchased additional chairs from Kington Community Shop. It was during the week manned by Eardisland Bowling Club, and we thought we were going to get

25 chairs but 34 were delivered! We have replaced some of the chairs in the Yarn Barn and the rest have been stored up in the loft until the Dove has been completed, when some of them can be used there. The rest will be available as additional outside seating when required.

The Yarn Barn is now officially open, and we had a very successful first week starting on Sunday 1 June when members of St Mary's church, and local crafting friends, came to see what is on offer. This was followed by our first advertised sessions on Monday and Wednesday from 10am to 12 noon. Everyone who has come so far, has been very impressed with the facilities and the variety of activities on offer, and all seem keen to come again. We are offering the chance for people to learn a range of crafts including:- many different types of weaving; spinning wool on a drop spindle or spinning wheel; knitting and crochet at all levels, – all with tea or coffee and biscuits. If you'd like to give it a try, either contact us by email or just turn up. We'd love to see you.

Freda and Alison
yarnbarn37@gmail.com

MUSIC @St Mary's

We will be in the Community Shop from **15th-22nd July**. As before, we are raising money to support the work of the choir and the running costs/maintenance of the organ.

We would very much welcome donations for sale and raffle prizes. Please bring them to church, place in the choir vestry or get in touch with Philip (01544) 239357 to arrange collection. Offers of help with running the shop very welcome!

“Farewell to Stephen”

Marion Giddings asked me if we could publish my “*Farewell to Stephen*” which grand-daughter Thalia had read at his funeral. I was delighted if it helped share the gratitude and admiration we all had for him. And I was also pleased having written two other versions of this prayer cum poem for friends who died last year. My use of words and ideas from the Book of Ecclesiastes is acknowledged in the first couple of lines: “Thank you old Prophet for borrowing your words!” Ideas more than words. I’ve wanted to reassure that this “tattered tent” of our bodies will eventually be shed, and we continue with new transformed bodies with our Lord in eternity. Stephen knew and felt this deeply! And we know that the names of Kath and Sarah are also written in the book of life. Thank you dear Stephen.

Thank you

We cannot begin to thank everyone individually for the many cards/letters, flowers, telephone calls and offers of help following Stephens passing.

Family, friends and neighbours have all been a tremendous support.

The attendance at the funeral service spoke volumes, the staff and children paying their respects outside the Primary School showed how much he was thought of.

A huge thank you to A.W. Hughes and Son for looking after us so well and to Geinor for the fabulous catering in the Church.

Grateful thanks to the Rev. Paul, Rev. Mike, organist Phillip and the Choir for their contribution towards what many have called “a lovely service”, one that Stephen would have been pleased.

R.I.P. Steve, a wonderful husband and father.

Marion and Naomi.

With gratitude, *Farewell to Stephen*

Forgive me old prophets if I borrow your words

The old are the best; like migrating birds

When that silver cord is snapped

And the golden bowl is cracked

When the life-long pitcher at the fountain

Shattered and useless lies

We are ready to make our journey.

The grinding of the mill is done,

The wheel at the well now broken,

Dreams of clean water unspoken,

We return to our eternal home.

Perhaps a little fear, the unknown

This world’s tent tattered and torn

Ragged, unfit to be borne.

“I know where I am going” he said. “I shall wait for you there!”

And we remember dear Kath and our Sarah, Lord
We know your arms enfold them, safe and very dear.

Let the Huntington organ no more play its tricks,
Or the mischief of organ stools worries us to bits.

Dear Stephen, you were packed and ready,
confident.

Come! Our Lord said, ‘*I am the way, and the truth, and the life*’

Our worn things left behind, our path signed;
Yes, Lord,

Steve said, I know my name is written in the
book of life

Keyboard playing by candle light, the stars dim.

Friends, colleagues, dear neighbours, Thank
you.

Spring sun, blackbird song, for family, for joy,
Thank you.

Amen, Amen

Robert MacCurrach June 2026

Not a Proper Gardener (Part 64)

I'm writing this on June 6th, and the weather is playing tricks on us. It has decided to go into reverse. From an exceptionally dry spell in May – a heatwave with temperatures soaring into the twenties like midsummer in June/July, too hot to do much in the garden! – now it seems to have gone back into March winds, April showers, with temperatures in the teens, too wet to do much in the garden! But who knows what these showers will bring forth? November fogs perhaps! Well, it's all good fun. Gardening's hardly boring!

And it's not only the weather that's playing tricks on us. Some sweet pea seeds (Old spice mix – I've found the empty packet), sown in my coir pots, produced healthy plants which Emma planted out by some trellis. It tricked us by producing white flowers on short stems, and then long, fat pods. We are enjoying tasty sugar-snap peas rather than pretty flowers!

They say things run in threes. Emma knows that sheep wool put round plants could put off slugs. So Giles gathered up for her bits of wool, shed by the sheep in the meadows where we walk, and she put it round my coir pot beans she had planted out. "Thanks very much," said the dicky birds, "just what we need for our nests! Furthermore, we like this soil you have just dug over. Perfect for dust baths."

Despite all this the garden is being, and has been, productive. The kale has come on really well at last, and the broad beans are ready to eat. Some of the pippins we've kept from last year are still perfect – in June! We've super pea plants in coir pots just planted out. Hopefully they won't turn out to be sweet peas as Emma has put them in the vegetable patch! Unfortunately ground elder is also doing very well, and so we're glad that we have a brown bin for garden rubbish to be collected.



Of course there are sad things to report as well. The patio pear's blossom was caught by the frost, so no pears there. Also, the aged apple trees, cookers, already old when we moved in, are slowly dying, the Medlar tree, was badly broken by a football and a standard gooseberry wrecked by a storm. A bit of work on those in the autumn.

The livestock is a constant interest, especially for Emma. The hedgehogs enjoy their bedtime feed of calci worms, as do the naughty blackbirds who hang around waiting to pinch some, and there are starlings, sparrows, robins, and an occasional bullfinch, with fledglings everywhere. I am always amused to come into our kitchen and find a couple of blackbirds looking in at us, hoping for apple cores. One, an extra nosey one, and so nicknamed Parker, has been known to come in through an open window seeking food. The other is Nike, with a white tick on his body, hopeful hanger-on.

Happy gardening, Denis.

Annual WI trip to Aberystwyth

Wednesday 12th August

9am from Mill Street.

£20.

Please contact

Pat Roberts, 01544 231000

or Margaret Cooke, 01544 230805
to book

OAK | Open Arms Kington July events



Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kington, July 2026.

Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).

Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.

Wednesday 1st July, 10am-12.30pm. *Sunflower Social at Places of Welcome.* A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Monday 6th July, 10.30am-12.30pm. *Digital Skills Lessons 1:* Staying safe online and avoiding scams, with Richard Connelly of AbilityNet. Booking essential, please email Kim at kim@openarmskington.co.uk to book or call 07301 081444. Free.

Wednesday 8th July, 10am-12.30pm. *Dementia Matters at Places of Welcome.* Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Sunday 12th July, 1-5pm. *Bastille Day.* Join us for a French-themed celebration, with pétanque, quiz, music, and French food. Free.

Monday 20th July, 10.30am-12.30pm. *Digital Skills Lessons 2:* Getting to know your mobile phone, with Richard Connelly of AbilityNet. Booking essential, please email Kim at kim@openarmskington.co.uk to book or call 07301 081444. Free.

Sunday 26th July, 2-4pm. *Creative Workshop at The Oxford Arms.* This month's activity is sun printing with anthotypes! Payment by donation (suggested £5). Live 100 Club draw at 3pm. Bar and café open 1-5pm.

Friday 31st July, 6-10pm. *Quiz night at The Oxford Arms.* Teams of max 4 people, £3pp entry, cash prize for the winning team. Bar open throughout.

Regular opening hours in July:

Places of Welcome at The Oxford Arms, every Wednesday morning in July, 10am-12.30pm

Country Market at The Oxford Arms, every Friday morning in July, 9am-12pm

OAK | Open Arms Kington CiC www.openarmskington.co.uk comms@openarmskington.co.uk

July

Please get in touch if your group is within a 10 mile radius of Kington and would like to be added to a small waiting list who will be offered any vacancies as they arise

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Knill Church

Almeley Church

Music @ St. Marys

Marchers Makers Festival

Huntington Church

News From the Museum

Mills of Kington

There were 15 mills in and around the Kington area situated on the Gilwern, Back, Gladestry Brooks, also the River Arrow. They were not only grain mills for corn, but a woollen mill.

The woollen mill (sometimes called The Weaving Mill) was situated on the Gilwern Brook which at that time was flowing past the old Meredith Foundry. After Duncan & Alexander bought the Foundry in the 1900's, selling on to J.H. Langston in 1926, who founded the Kington Economy Laundry. They adapted the buildings to suit their use, installing 3 turbines to power the machinery and heat the water. The leet has now been filled in, there was a sluice gate too, but the weir can be seen from the by pass road at Sunset roundabout.

The mill race, supplying power for a woollen factory, but may of carried out the other processes of the woollen cloth too, perhaps supplying to cottage weavers. The Mill was named in Parry's book (1843) as Crabtree Mill. This now where Sergeants Bus Depot is. One can follow the paths of the mills around Kington along the River Arrow and the Back Brook. The Mill at Crooked Well was converted to pump water into the town, giving Kington its first piped water supply.

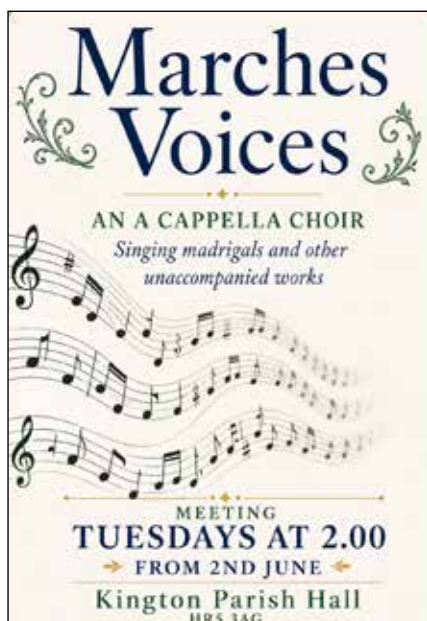
Another well-known mill is Turner's of course, which was named Arrow Mill bought in 1834 by Thomas purchased from his brothers and sisters paying £1,800 for it. During the 19th century a turbine was fitted and later a steam engine to increase the power, causing a name change to "The Arrow Lodge Steam Corn Mills". Thomas increased its business activities. By 1900 a malting had been added and the Mill trading as John and Phillip Turner, Maltster and Millers. The Mill provided both flour and grist, and had its own bakery, delivering bread over a wide area with a horse and cart. Turner's has developed today with the Garden Centre, whilst still supplying feed.

The Passey Nott Seed and Grain Merchant partnership was a very old one. The Passey family owning Bullocks Mill, a corn mill known as Haywards Mill, while Titley Mill earlier one known as Lords Mill. Bullocks mill is probably the best documented mill in the county, changing hands many times since 1580 before finishing its working life to be converted into a turbine electricity generator for the Whittern.

The mills around Kington were used in many industries from the Tanyard, which it is believed to have driven the bark cutter, to the town's early electricity, to the woollen trade. There were weaving mills, for the flannel cloth manufacturers and other processes for the cloth trade. Kington had tailors making garments for the local population.

There are many remains of the mills from derelict buildings, others developed into housing, the brickwork of the leets to pits for the wooden wheels. In the Museum are records of where the mills were situated, along with the technical information of the building and the construction, whether it was stone or wood.

Wendy Jones



Kington Benefice Pilgrim Path Project 2026

Guided Circular Pilgrim Trails from our churches

The churches of the Kington Benefice offer you the hospitality of their buildings, which are open daily and the opportunity to explore the local environment along ancient ways, through outstanding landscapes.

We invite you to make these short pilgrim journeys in a spirit of openness to what it might offer, delight in the countryside through which you travel and companionship with those who have travelled this way before and will do so after you.

Accompanied by experienced guides, there will be opportunities for conversation and reflection, encounter and exploration.



Start Time: 1.45 pm for prompt 2.00 pm start

Meeting at: Church Door

Refreshments available on return

21 June	St Stephen's Old Radnor LD8 2RL
19 July	St Peter's Titley HR5 3RR
16 August	St Thomas à Becket Huntington HR5 3PY
20 September	St Mary's Kington HR5 3AG

Free to join, but booking essential as places limited

Booking: Judith Pollard - wotzpollard@aol.com

Enquiries: Sally Welch - vicar@kingtonparishes.org.uk

Telephone: 07974439630

Caring for God's Acre

Taking a Look at Hoverflies

Why not take time out on a sunny, calm July day and sit down in your local churchyard, chapel yard or cemetery next to a flowering plant such as hogweed, yarrow or knapweed. After a while you may notice that there is a wealth of variety amongst the various bee-like insects who are visiting the flowers.

Whilst bees meander from flower to flower at a fairly constant speed, you'll also spot another group of insects, similarly banded in yellow and black, which dart quickly and then hover, staying quite still, like a miniature hummingbird. These are

hoverflies and there are an amazing 280 different species in the UK, found in a wide range of habitats. Hoverflies often look

quite like bees or wasps, with stripey, sometimes furry bodies. They do not sting however but this mimicry discourages predators as the yellow and black stripes spell danger! Look closely and you'll see two large eyes and a single pair of wings, characteristics of flies (bees and wasps have two pairs of wings). The hoverfly beats these wings up and down several hundred times per second to stay stationary.

Hoverflies are a true friend to the gardener, the adults are important pollinators and nearly half of our hoverfly larvae feed on aphids and other plant sap-suckers. Others eat fungi, yeasts, micro-organism and general detritus found in the soil, in deadwood and in stagnant water. They are key decomposers and recyclers. Many gardeners encourage hoverflies by planting suitable flowers for them. Open flowers such as alyssums, yarrows, daisies and marjoram will all

Hoverflies are a true friend to the gardener, the adults are important pollinators and nearly half of our hoverfly larvae feed on aphids and other plant sap-suckers.



provide a good source of nectar. Many of the wildflowers found in churchyards are great for hoverflies too, do you have cow parsley, chervil or wild carrot (or any of the umbel family), how about daisies, yarrow, dandelions and hawkweeds? Hoverflies have

mouthparts that dab at the flowers rather like a sponge so choose flat, open flowers.

Hoverflies are an example of an insect group which is often overlooked, easily passed off as a bee

until you look more closely. They are an important part of our ecosystem however and, like butterflies, are sensitive indicators of environmental change. As well letting some grassland grow long so the wildflowers can bloom, how about planting suitable flowers if you have beds or planters? Creating a deadwood pile in a shady spot is great for hoverflies as well as so many other species and leaving some leaf litter and woody debris under tree canopies supports pupae or, in some cases, overwintering adults, ready to emerge in the spring.

So have a look for hoverflies this summer and, if you are patient, photograph them hovering and feeding. This can help to identify what you have seen.

Harriet Carty

Diocesan Churchyard Environmental Advisor

KINGTON TOWN COUNCIL UPDATE



This time of year, has seen the annual change-over of roles on the council, time to choose a new Mayor, Deputy and chairs of the various committees.



I have the honour of being elected as Mayor and my colleague, councillor Buzz Bishop elected as deputy. I follow councillor Philip Sell who has been Mayor for the past two years and we thank him for his dedication and professionalism with which he led the council.

One of my first duties as Mayor was to chair the annual town meeting where Councillor Sell was delighted to present Emma Hancocks with a special award. As many of you will know Emma works tirelessly for the good of Kington being Chair of the Chamber of Trade and is involved in so many events held in the town, we would be lost without her. I would like to add my congratulations to Emma and thanks for all you do.

It has been great to see the initiative taken by some people in helping to smarten up the town, witness the nice white bollards outside to the market hall. It's great to see people taking pride in our town instead of taking to social media and complaining. As a council we want to hear of your concerns so that we can either take the appropriate action or make sure the relevant body is aware. We can't always resolve matters, but we will try and will keep you informed.

Let's all take pride in Kington and do our best together to make in an even better place to live.

Cllr. Martin Woolford. Mayor

St Stephen's Church

We are thrilled to announce that St Stephen's Church has received a grant from The National Lottery Heritage Fund to save our beautiful marble Lewis Monument, which is currently in serious danger of collapse. We will also be supported by the Church Commissioners to address the damp and drainage problems in the chancel and chapel. These problems have, over time, contributed to the deterioration of the monument. Thanks to the funding, we will be able to both save the monument and tackle the cause of it, to ensure it doesn't happen again.

Alongside the conservation work, we have plans for a programme of community activities which we hope will attract people from all over the benefice. The programme will include talks, guided tours, behind-the-scenes conservation sessions, nature-focused churchyard activities, a memory-sharing event, archive research and new accessible interpretation, including a church guide and children's trail! Keep an eye out for a new Facebook page where you'll be kept updated about what's happening.

The project kicked off on Friday 5 June with our first event: New Radnor resident and historian Dr Marion Evans kindly offered to give a talk on the archaeology of the Radnor Valley – and the church was packed! Thanks as always to Rosemary and her team for sorting a wonderful spread, and to Marion for generously donating the wine. The talk raised a whopping £930, which will go towards the project, as we still have some funds to raise. We're now applying to the National Lottery Community Fund for an Awards for All grant, and if we are successful with that, we'll be able to deliver a more extensive programme of events and activities, AND maybe start planning for a WC! So please keep your fingers crossed, and if you would like to help in any way, or to find out more about our plans, please email oldradnorheritage@gmail.com.

All for One - and One for All!

This summer, Illyria Outdoor Theatre will be performing The Three Musketeers at Yatton Court, Aymestrey on Friday 31st July at 7pm.

Yatton Court is an 18th Century manor house and the performance, befitting the occasion, will take place in its grounds. Set against a sweeping panorama of 17th century France at war, the Three Musketeers is a whirlwind of excitement, comedy and ingenious storytelling. Romance! Intrigue! Murder! Betrayal! Revenge...! It's got the lot!

Young D'Artagnan is desperate to join Athos, Porthos and Aramis as an elite Musketeer of the King's Guard. To prove himself he plunges headlong into a thrilling adventure to retrieve the Queen's jewels, race the clock to restore Her Majesty's honour, survive the machinations of scheming Cardinal Richelieu, and cross swords with the deadly Milady de Winter.

With a reputation for staging some of the finest swordplay in the business, Illyria's The Three Musketeers promises to be more dazzling than ever! So, bring a picnic and a seat and immerse yourself in this electrifying experience. The proceeds will go to Aymestrey Church and Aymestrey Parish Hall.

The show will run for approximately 135 minutes, including a 20-minute interval and is recommended for ages 8+ as the Play contains scenes of peril, politics and passion! Younger children are welcome, if they're brave enough...

Bring your own seating/rug, suitable clothing & picnic. Only assistance dogs are permitted. Venue is wheelchair accessible by prior arrangement - email hello@alisonarcher.co.uk Car parking is 200m from performance area. The doors will open at 6pm and the performance starts at 7pm

To book your tickets visit: Illyria.co.uk



KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

Come and enjoy a 2-course meal in a friendly environment with other local seniors at:

Kington Parish Hall

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Cost is £6

We meet on the
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Next lunch is on 15th July

Contact: Rose 01544 230174



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From Lady Hawkins School

*As part of our English lessons, we have been reading the novel **Another Twist in the Tale** by Catherine Bruton. The story is inspired by Oliver Twist and explores what life was like for children living in Victorian London. Our Year 7 students were inspired to imagine what it would have felt like to walk through the busy streets of London at that time. In this piece of descriptive writing, **Beth Nixon-Hall** tried to capture the sights, sounds and atmosphere of the city, while also showing the contrast between the rich and the poor.*
Miss Moss

In London, it was never quiet. All I could hear were the countless footsteps hurrying past and the wheels scraping along the streets beneath me, along with the occasional whistle of steam trains rumbling across the city. The air was thick with fog and polluted by smoke, making me choke. The streets seemed to sink beneath me and swallow me whole as I stared up at the tall buildings towering overhead. Everything moved at full speed as people pushed past one another: women in colourful skirts that brushed the ground and men in tailored suits who came from wealthy homes filled with warm meals and servants.

The streets of London never seemed to rest. The world around me roared with noise, pushing me from side to side. Everywhere I looked, I could see the divide between rich and poor: the beggars and the buyers. Fog hung over the city like a heavy blanket, covering the sky and hiding the world from sunlight and hope. At night, the only light came from the dim, dying lamps that lined the wealthy streets and the poor were left to suffer in darkness.

As I continued through the crowded streets, I noticed the contrast between different parts of the city. In the richer areas, large houses stood proudly behind iron gates, their windows glowing warmly against the dark sky. Laughter and music drifted from inside, carrying the scent of freshly cooked meals into the streets. Only a short distance away, families huddled together in cramped, crumbling buildings. Children wandered the streets in worn clothing, searching for food and work.

Beth Nixon-Hall

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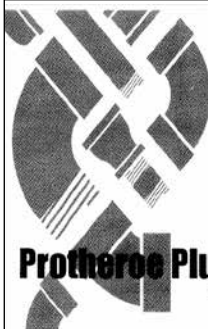
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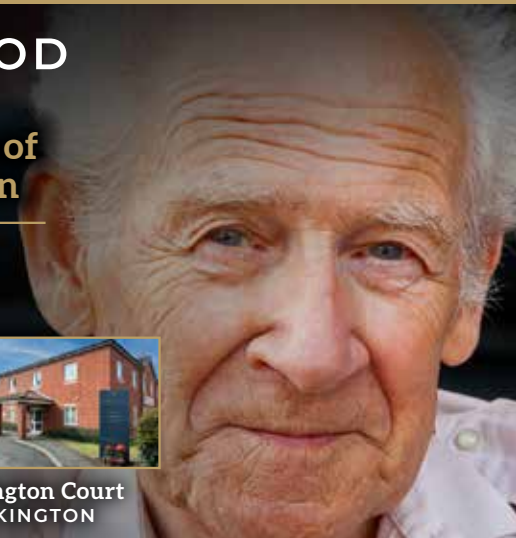
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41	41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30	
06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39	
06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05	
	08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-	

41	41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03	
06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07	
07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27	
07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37	

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School holidays + Sat

Please verify with Sargeants for the most up to date timings and if Sunday buses are running on the route you require.

Forthcoming events

<i>June</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Sat 27 th	11.00am	Armed Forces Day Parade	Lady Hawkins School
Sat 27 th	1.00pm	Smokefest	KT Football Club
Sun 28 th	10am – 4pm	Kington Street Market	Kington High St
Sun 28 th	6.00 pm	Choral Evensong (rehearsal at 5.00 pm)	Huntington Church
<i>July</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Fri 3 rd	10.00– 11.30am	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Fri 3 rd	7.30pm	Kington Choral Society Summer Concert	St Andrew's, Presteigne
Fri 3 rd	7.00pm	Recital by Hilary Norris (organ) and Joris Boon (cello)	St Mary's, Kington
Mon 6 th	12.15 – 1.30pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Sun 5 th	2.30 – 5.00pm	Cream Teas at St Mary's	St Mary's Church
<i>Every Sunday during July & August</i>			
Sun 5 th	6.00pm	Prayer and Praise Evening	St Mary's
Tues 7 th	9.15 – 10.45	Stay & Play Babies and Toddlers	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Tues 7 th	2.00pm	Marches Voices Madrigal Group	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated weekly</i>			
Tues 7 th	7.00pm	St Mary's PCC	Parish Hall
Tues 14 th	7.00pm	Beetle Drive	Parish Hall
Sat 11 th	2.30pm	Old Radnor Church Fete	The Hymns, Walton LD8 2RA
Sun 12 th	12.30pm	Wild Church Cook Out	Yeld Wood, Hergest Ridge
Sat 18 th	9.30 – 3.30	Kington Craft Market	Market Hall, Kington
Wed 22 nd	3.30pm	Lego Club	St Mary's, Kington
Sun 26 th	6.00pm	Choral Evensong	Huntington Church
<i>(rehearsal at 5.00 pm)</i>			
Thurs 30 th	7.30pm	Kington Community Choir: Songs of the Summer	The Burton Hotel, Kington

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 9

*You can also find details of many cultural events and activities in
Broad Sheep: www.broadsheep.com and www.visitherefordshire.co.uk*

*If you would like a church or community event publicised in the Diary please contact the Diary
Editor: Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com*

MATERIAL FOR THE AUGUST 2026 PARISH NEWS

by **10th July 2026**

Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:

pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Note: The cut-off date is always the 10th of the previous month